

Diversity Policy

VERSION 1.0	EFFECTIVE	NEXT REVIEW	OWNER Principal / Key Management Personnel	APPROVED BY Governing body
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PURPOSE AT A GLANCE

This policy explains how [] identifies and sensitively responds to each participant's culture, diversity, values and beliefs — at the participant's direction — and supports their right to practise their culture, values and beliefs while accessing support.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy supports [] to apply the Individual Values and Beliefs NDIS Practice Standards. It applies to all services and supports delivered by [] and to all employees, contractors and volunteers (**Workers**), who must take full responsibility for understanding and following it. It should be read alongside the related documents in the final section and the corresponding procedures in the Policy Register.

2. Policy aims

[] is committed to ensuring that:

- at the direction of the participant, the culture, diversity, values and beliefs of that participant are identified and sensitively responded to; and
- each participant's right to practise their culture, values and beliefs while accessing support is supported.

3. An inclusive environment

[] creates an environment where everyone is treated with dignity and respect and where the traditions and histories of different groups are valued. [] supports diversity across languages, religions, ethnicity, cultures, abilities, sexual orientations, personal characteristics and backgrounds, and: treats everyone uniquely so individual needs are met; provides a welcoming, accessible, confidential and culturally appropriate environment; recognises and respects the diversity of its workers, participants and their families and communities; ensures participants with diverse needs can access services free from stigma, discrimination and stereotyping; is responsive, inclusive and sensitive to participants who are lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender or intersex; and acknowledges and respects each person's individual needs, history, life experiences and personal choices.

4. At the participant's direction

At the direction of the participant, [] identifies and responds to the participant's culture, diversity, values and beliefs — recording them in the Client Intake Form and Client Support Plan — and ensures services are culturally appropriate and sensitive to the confidentiality of personal diversity as the participant determines. Communication is provided in the language, mode of communication and terms the participant is most likely to understand.

5. Workers

All workers are skilled in inclusive practice and service delivery, keep service delivery free of discrimination (including indirect discrimination) and harassment (including bullying), and respect local cultural etiquette, protocol and communication techniques. The Work Health and Safety and Risk Management policies include strategies to identify and manage risks to diversity and equality.

6. Definitions

[redacted]
[redacted], ABN [redacted].

Client

A client of [redacted], including an NDIS participant.

Key Management Personnel (KMP)

[redacted], and other key management personnel involved in [redacted] from time to time.

Principal

[redacted].

Legislation Register

The register of legislation, regulations, rules and guidelines maintained by [redacted].

Policy Register

The register of policies of [redacted].

Worker

A permanent, fixed-term or casual member of staff, a contractor or a volunteer engaged by [redacted], including the Principal.

7. Related documents and approval

Related documents: Client Intake Form · Client Support Plan · Promoting and Protecting Rights · Choice, Advocacy and Control Policy · Privacy and Dignity Policy · Preventing and Responding to Violence, Abuse, Neglect, Exploitation and Discrimination Policy · Human Resources Management Policy · Legislation Register · Policy Register.

Legislation and rules: as set out in the Legislation Register. If any part of this policy is inconsistent with applicable law, it is taken to be amended only to the extent needed to comply.

Approved by	[redacted]
Approval date	[redacted]
Next scheduled review	
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